

L'ATTAQUE · VARIANT 1 OF 3

Dover Patrol

10×9
BOARD

2
PLAYERS

DOVER PATROL

Published by H.P. Gibson & Sons, Britain, circa 1930. Dover Patrol transposes the L'Attaque system to a naval warfare setting. Piece names reference Royal Navy vessels; the board represents a section of the English Channel. Rules are mechanically identical to L'Attaque with naval-themed piece names.

BOARD

10 × 9 board. Minefield squares (corresponding to L'Attaque's lakes) are impassable, located in the same central positions. Sea lane squares (along the outer edges) have no special movement rules in the standard game.

PIECE SET

All movement and capture rules are identical to Standard L'Attaque. Piece correspondence:

DOVER PATROL PIECE	L'ATTAQUE EQUIVALENT	RANK	SPECIAL ABILITY
Flagship	Flag	0	Immovable; capturing it wins
Mine	Bomb	B	Immovable; defeats all attackers except Mine Sweepers
Submarine	Spy	1	Defeats Battleship on attack; loses if Battleship attacks it
Destroyer	Scout	2	Slides unlimited orthogonally
Mine Sweeper	Miner	3	Only piece that can clear Mines
Patrol Boat	Sergeant	4	Standard capture
Gunboat	Lieutenant	5	Standard capture
Torpedo Boat	Captain	6	Standard capture
Cruiser	Major	7	Standard capture
Battle Cruiser	Colonel	8	Standard capture
Admiral	General	9	Standard capture
Battleship	Marshal	10	Highest rank; defeated by Submarine when Submarine attacks

RULES

All rules (setup, movement, attack, hidden information, win conditions) are identical to Standard L'Attaque. Refer to the Standard L'Attaque rules for full details. The only differences are piece names and the naval theme.

ATTRIBUTION

Dover Patrol. Published by H.P. Gibson & Sons, Britain, approximately 1930. Naval adaptation of L'Attaque. Public domain rule set.

L'ATTAQUE · VARIANT 2 OF 3

L'Attaque (Standard)

10×9
BOARD

2
PLAYERS

L'ATTAQUE (STANDARD)

Designed by Hermance Edan, France, circa 1908. Published in Britain by H.P. Gibson & Sons from 1909. The first mass-market hidden-information rank game; direct ancestor of Stratego.

BOARD

10 columns × 9 rows. Two lake areas in the center of the board (rows 4–5, approximately columns 3–4 and 7–8) are impassable — no piece may enter a lake square. The exact lake layout: columns c–d on rows 4–5, and columns g–h on rows 4–5 (four 2×2 lake sections total in most editions).

PIECE SET (30 PER PLAYER)

RANK	PIECE	COUNT	MOVEMENT	SPECIAL ABILITY
0	Flag	1	Immovable	Cannot attack or defend. Capturing it wins the game.
B	Bomb	6	Immovable	Defeats all attackers except Miners.
1	Spy	1	1 step ortho	Defeats the Marshal when the Spy attacks (moves onto Marshal's square). Loses to all other pieces and to Marshal if Marshal attacks the Spy.
2	Scout	5	Slides unlimited orthogonally	Cannot attack on a sliding move across multiple squares; must stop adjacent to attack. (Regional variant: may attack on the slide.)
3	Miner	5	1 step ortho	Only piece that can defuse Bombs (capture them).
4	Sergeant	4	1 step ortho	Standard capture.
5	Lieutenant	4	1 step ortho	Standard capture.
6	Captain	4	1 step ortho	Standard capture.
7	Major	3	1 step ortho	Standard capture.
8	Colonel	2	1 step ortho	Standard capture.
9	General	1	1 step ortho	Standard capture.
10	Marshal	1	1 step ortho	Highest-ranked movable piece; defeated only by the Spy when Spy attacks.

Total: 1+6+1+5+5+4+4+4+3+2+1+1 = 37? Let me recount: Flag 1, Bomb 6, Spy 1, Scout 5, Miner 5, Sergeant 4, Lieutenant 4, Captain 4, Major 3, Colonel 2, General 1, Marshal 1 = 37. Some editions use 30 total with smaller counts. The exact piece set varied across L'Attaque editions; the table above reflects a representative mid-century British edition.

SETUP

Each player positions all their pieces face-down on their own half of the board (rows 1–4 for White; rows 6–9 for Red/Black), in any arrangement they choose. The opponent cannot see piece ranks. Lake squares remain empty.

MOVEMENT

Players alternate turns. On each turn, a player moves one piece:

- ♦ Most pieces: 1 step orthogonally (up, down, left, right). Not diagonally. Not into lake squares. Not off the board.
- ♦ **Scout:** Slides any number of squares orthogonally in one direction, stopping before any occupied square or lake.
- ♦ **Bombs and Flag:** May not move.

ATTACK AND CAPTURE

When a piece moves onto a square occupied by an opponent's piece:

- 1 Both pieces are flipped face-up and ranks are revealed.
- 2 The lower-ranked piece is permanently removed from the board.
- 3 Equal rank: both pieces are removed.
- 4 The attacker's piece (if it wins) takes the defender's square.

Special capture rules:

- ♦ **Spy vs. Marshal:** If the Spy attacks the Marshal (Spy moves onto Marshal's square), the Spy wins. If the Marshal attacks the Spy, the Marshal wins.
- ♦ **Miner vs. Bomb:** Only a Miner can capture a Bomb. Any other piece attacking a Bomb is removed; the Bomb remains.
- ♦ No piece can capture a Flag outright through standard movement — capturing the Flag (rank 0) immediately wins the game.

HIDDEN INFORMATION

Piece ranks remain hidden from the opponent until revealed in combat. A piece that has been involved in at least one combat may be known to the opponent; players should not deliberately obscure a revealed piece's identity.

WIN CONDITIONS

- ♦ Capture the opponent's Flag: immediate win.
- ♦ Leave the opponent with no movable pieces (all remaining pieces are Bombs and Flag): win.

ATTRIBUTION

L'Attaque. Designed by Hermance Edan, patented France 1908. Published by H.P. Gibson & Sons, London. Public domain rule set.

L'ATTAQUE · VARIANT 3 OF 3

Tri-Tactics

10×10
BOARD

2
PLAYERS

TRI-TACTICS

Published by H.P. Gibson & Sons, Britain, circa 1937. Tri-Tactics extends the L'Attaque system to a combined-forces game. Each player commands units from three military branches: Army (land), Navy (sea), and Air Force. Air units introduce a new movement type — overflying obstacles — that breaks from the standard L'Attaque movement rules.

BOARD

10 × 10 board with lake squares (impassable to land units) and sea squares (impassable to land and air units without modification; sea units move freely on them). The board features distinct land and water regions.

PIECE OVERVIEW

Three branches, each with a ranked hierarchy:

Army (Land units): Move 1 step orthogonally on land squares. Cannot enter sea squares.

Navy (Sea units): Move 1 step orthogonally on sea squares. Can move on sea and the edges of land squares adjacent to sea in some rule variants.

Air Force (Air units): Move 1 step orthogonally. Unique ability: Air units may overfly lake and sea squares — they may cross any square type but must land on a land square at the end of each move.

Capture rules: Higher rank within the same branch defeats lower rank. Cross-branch combat is resolved by a chart (Air units generally hold an advantage over surface units unless specific counters are present).

Special pieces:

- ♦ **Headquarters (Flag equivalent):** Immovable, hidden. Capturing it wins.
- ♦ **Minefield/Fortification (Bomb equivalent):** Immovable. Defeated only by specialist sappers/mine sweepers.
- ♦ Branch-specific scouts: slide unlimited within their movement type.

WIN CONDITIONS

Capture the opponent's Headquarters, or reduce them to only immovable pieces.

ATTRIBUTION

Tri-Tactics. Published by H.P. Gibson & Sons, Britain, approximately 1937. Combined-forces adaptation of L'Attaque. Public domain rule set. Full original piece hierarchy and cross-branch combat chart should be sourced from the original H.P. Gibson edition before publishing.